

Chapter 85 - Couples

Feng Yue stumbled halfway down and was much more cautious when sliding down.

This time Yan Lin followed her closely, constantly watching for potential hazards and other skiers both ahead and behind them.

Fortunately, the two of them safely reached the bottom this time.

As soon as they reached the end, Yan Lin was the first to take off her snowboard, then walked to Feng Yue's side and crouched down to help her remove her snowboard before she could bend down herself.

This wasn't the first time Feng Yue had fallen, but it was her first time being tripped while sliding at such high speed, and she was indeed startled.

Yan Lin carried both their snowboards with one hand and used her other hand to pull Feng Yue to the rest area to sit down.

"Were you tripped just now? Did you sprain your ankle or anything?" Saying this, Yan Lin crouched down and was about to help Feng Yue take off her shoes.

Seeing her movement, Feng Yue's whole body stiffened, then she drew her legs back and stood up, bouncing slightly. "I'm fine, just got tripped a bit. I'm not hurt anywhere."

Yan Lin's outstretched hand froze there. Only after seeing Feng Yue stand up and bounce did she quietly retract her hand to her side, her fingers curling into her sleeves, silently rubbing them for a moment.

This incident was just a small accident during their skiing, and it wasn't long before both of them put it behind them.

This mishap didn't dampen Feng Yue's enthusiasm for skiing; instead, it awakened some stubborn spirit within her heart. She urgently wanted to ski again.

So when the two stood at the starting point of the slope again, Feng Yue once more dove down without hesitation.

Yan Lin watched her high-spirited appearance, and a hint of a smile overflowed from her eyes hidden behind the goggles.

But accidents happen in an instant. When Feng Yue was sliding past the biggest slope, two tourists who had stopped in the middle of the slope suddenly appeared in front of her.

Feng Yue was skiing quite fast, and slowing down gradually wouldn't be enough to stop in time. Her heart tightened, and she even became somewhat panicked.

"A Yue, avoid them to the left!"

Yan Lin's voice from behind reached Feng Yue's ears. She immediately snapped back to her senses, leaning to the left side. Her right foot immediately pushed outward with force, the inner edge of her snowboard carving into the snow, bringing up a large spray of snow.

Feng Yue stopped on the left side of the slope. Seeing this, Yan Lin breathed a sigh of relief, then turned her gaze to the man and woman stopped in the middle of the slope. She adjusted her center of gravity to switch to front-edge skiing while placing her weight on her toes, pressing her edges into the snow and bringing up a large spray of flying snowflakes.

Yan Lin came to a halt right behind the couple, and naturally, the white spray of snow splashed all over them both.

"Sorry." Yan Lin looked down at the two with a condescending glance, then controlled her snowboard to slide to Feng Yue's side.

"Those two are the couple that scared you just now." Yan Lin said, looking at Feng Yue who was obviously startled.

She had recognized their clothing when she shouted for Feng Yue to turn and brake.

That couple naturally wasn't pleased about being splashed with snow for no reason. The woman was particularly hot-tempered. Seeing Yan Lin and the other stop by the barrier, she took off her snowboard and walked toward them.

She opened her mouth with less than fluent English: "Hey, if you can't ski, you can go to the children's area. Is it fun to deliberately splash people with snow?"

Hearing this, Feng Yue's face became extremely ugly. Everyone knows not to stop in the middle of a slope. She had almost crashed into them because she couldn't brake in time, yet this woman could still be so self-righteous in questioning them.

Feng Yue tore off the goggles from her face and glared fiercely at the other party. "Miss, I think the ones who should go to the children's area are you two. When you entered the slope, didn't you see the prominent sign? No stopping in the middle of the slope is prohibited. If you can't read, I suggest you don't come out to play, otherwise you might not find your way home."

The woman was furious and was about to curse, but the man beside her seemed to feel guilty as well, so he hastily apologized and tried to pull his girlfriend away.

Feng Yue and Yan Lin weren't injured, and since the man had apologized, they thought the matter was over.

But unexpectedly, before turning to leave, the woman viciously rolled her eyes at Feng Yue and said: "tête du f!."

Feng Yue was obviously stunned. She could understand that the other party was speaking French, but she didn't know what it meant.

But Yan Lin beside her suddenly changed expression, stepped forward on her snowboard, and grabbed the woman's arm. Her voice became terrifyingly deep, and equally fluent French came out of her mouth: "S'excuser avec elle². (Apologize to her)"

The woman probably didn't expect Yan Lin to understand what she said, much less that this person in front of her spoke such fluent French.

"Hey—" The man naturally heard what his girlfriend said, so when he saw Yan Lin reach out to stop them, he instinctively wanted to defend his girlfriend.

However, Yan Lin just took off her goggles and looked at him coldly. The man's words were cut off.

"S'excuser avec elle." Yan Lin raised her voice and repeated, with a hint of anger in her tone.

But the woman remained unrepentant and rattled off a long string in French.

Instead, the man beside her tugged at her arm, wanting her to apologize and settle the matter peacefully.

But the woman firmly refused, even looking at Yan Lin challengingly.

Her boyfriend looked helpless and took the initiative to say to Feng Yue in English: "I'm really sorry that my girlfriend said such things. She didn't mean it."

Feng Yue understood the French man's English, but she didn't respond to his apology at all. She hadn't understood what the woman had said, but she could somewhat guess it probably wasn't anything good, otherwise Yan Lin wouldn't have directly stopped them.

Seeing that Feng Yue didn't respond at all, the man knew this person couldn't be easily fooled, so he could only frown and communicate with his girlfriend, hoping she would apologize quickly so they could leave the slope.

The woman, constantly being asked to apologize by her boyfriend, was somewhat embarrassed, her face flushed red with suppressed anger.

But after a while, she seemed to think of something, rolled her eyes, suddenly smiled, and said to Yan Lin in English: "I can apologize, but I never apologize to people weaker than us. You compete with my boyfriend once. If you win, I'll apologize to your girlfriend. If you lose, you admit that you're all stupid tête dufs."

Hearing this, Feng Yue frowned, and the man beside them didn't look pleased either.

But Yan Lin stared deadly at the woman, then said: "Fine, compete in what?"

"Skiing." The woman looked down at the snowboard under Yan Lin's feet. "You're both on single boards, so let's compete once on the expert slope."

All three people present, upon hearing her words, had iron-blue faces, with her boyfriend's being the ugliest.

"Darling, why compete on the expert slope? That's too dangerous!"

"Martin, you're a professional, you can definitely beat her!"

Feng Yue looked at the woman with a crazy expression, and her native curse words³ almost slipped out.

Ski slopes are generally divided into beginner, intermediate, and advanced levels, but among the advanced slopes there are black diamond and double black diamond slopes. Double black diamond slopes are also called expert slopes.

On expert slopes, skiers face more treacherous terrain and obstacles. Narrow slopes, wind gaps, cliffs, rock piles, and forests—if a skier isn't careful, each of these obstacles could become the place where they lose their life.

Although Feng Yue couldn't stand this woman, she wasn't crazy enough to gamble with Yan Lin's life, especially since Yan Lin also suffered from a blood clotting disorder⁴. If something happened during skiing, she wouldn't be able to explain it to her parents.

So, just as Feng Yue was about to step forward to stop Yan Lin, she saw Yan Lin take the initiative to shake her head. "The expert slope is too dangerous. You two aren't worth me risking my body."

"However—" Yan Lin's tone changed, "We can go to the advanced slope. Tamanvi's⁵ advanced slope is 879 meters long total. That's the most suitable place."

"Good, then let's go to the advanced slope." The woman agreed immediately, completely not asking for her boyfriend's opinion.

Although Feng Yue knew Yan Lin probably had confidence, she still didn't want Yan Lin to compete. She opened her mouth, wanting to persuade Yan Lin to forget it.

But Yan Lin turned around first to comfort her: "Don't worry, it's fine. This woman must apologize to you."

Feng Yue fell silent. She was even guessing what that woman had said to make Yan Lin so angry.

"The word she said roughly translates to 'egghead' in French. Although it sounds like nothing, in French it's a word with serious racial discrimination⁶. She must apologize for her loose tongue."

After saying all this, Yan Lin turned around and began communicating with Martin. They now had to ski down first and then take the cable car up to the mountain top, where the starting point of the advanced slope was located.

Martin himself wasn't enthusiastic about this competition, even somewhat negative.

He and Yan Lin skied behind their respective sweethearts, guarding them as they slowly slid down.

At this time, Martin also said helplessly to Yan Lin: "Sorry she said those things."

"It's fine, she'll apologize for what she said."

Martin said: "Well, it's good that you're confident, but I have to regretfully tell you that my profession is ski instructor. You can't possibly win."

"However, I can go easy on you. After all, Vivian really should apologize to your friend."

Hearing this, Yan Lin didn't speak, only the corners of her mouth hidden under her face mask curved into a contemptuous smile.

She didn't need anyone to give her victory. She would make that woman apologize to Feng Yue willingly through facts.

The four safely reached the end of the intermediate slope, then took the cable car up to the advanced slope together.

This time, however, Feng Yue didn't sit separately from Yan Lin, but actively sat together with her. The couple also got on the cable car behind them.

Yan Lin was somewhat surprised by this, even a bit flustered. "A Yue, you..."

"Don't misunderstand, I just don't want that woman to have a chance to seize on this point and say something."

Yan Lin heard Feng Yue's words of clarification, but her heart felt somewhat sweet.

No matter what Feng Yue's reason was for actively approaching her, at least she was willing to get close.

Author's Note:

Yan Lin herself has hemophilia⁷. According to common sense, she shouldn't be able to engage in extreme sports, but here everyone should just consider that Yan Lin is a super genius who has never been injured since she started skiing.

Footnotes:

1. "Tête duf" - A French racial slur that literally means "egghead" but carries derogatory connotations about Asian people
2. "S'excuser avec elle" - French for "Apologize to her"
3. 国粹 (guócuì) - Literally "national essence," a euphemism for Chinese swear words
4. Blood clotting disorder - Refers to Yan Lin's hemophilia, a condition where blood doesn't clot properly
5. Tamanvi - Name of the ski resort location
6. Racial discrimination - The term used was specifically derogatory toward people of Asian descent
7. Hemophilia - A genetic disorder where blood doesn't clot properly, making any injury potentially dangerous

